

intrapreneurship, where people operate small businesses in the context of a bigger one.

You begin by doing the hard thing: Try to figure out what you can do that people will pay for. People have unlimited wants and needs. You just have to figure out what you can do to help them. Then concentrate on doing it better than anyone else.

Where to start? Our old friend Doug Casey recommends going to Kinshasha or Mumbai:

When I used to land in some Third World country where I knew no one and had no connections, what would I do—sit in my hotel room and watch TV? No. I'd open up the Yellow Pages for that city—it'd be online today—and look at the different kinds of businesses listed and think of ways I could offer some value to those people in those businesses, such that they would be willing to give me money in exchange. I always started with the people who tend to be centers of power—lawyers, real estate agents, and the like. In most places, they either have the money or know the people who do. I'd call them up and arrange an interview.

Here it's an advantage to be in a different town, preferably in a different country. They don't know who you are—for all they know, you're an eccentric billionaire, looking for opportunities. You're interesting, simply because you're from elsewhere. With some of them, you'll establish a rapport, and next thing you know, you're being invited home for dinner, you meet some of their friends, you keep your eyes and ears open, one thing leads to another, and you can find some great opportunities.

This technique works best for people who have a wide array of knowledge and other connections. If you've done nothing significant with your life previously it's a waste of time—why should these people want to talk to you after the first five minutes, when they're sizing you up? Hitting the ground in a strange, foreign country is doing something significant—an excellent start. It both allows you to see opportunities that most people don't (stuck as they are in their medieval serf mentality), and to bring some new intellectual capital to the party—a reason for those with the money to deal you in.